Prodigy Anesthesia Quick Review

Vertebroplasty

Vertebroplasty is performed to treat what condition?	Vertebroplasty is performed to treat compression fractures of the vertebrae. *Barash PG, Cullen BF, Stoelting RK, Cahalan MK, Stock MC, Ortega R. Clinical Anesthesia. 7th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Lippincott Williams and Wilkins; 2013: 1664.*
How is a vertebroplasty performed?	The patient is placed in the prone position and the back is prepped and draped. A fluoroscope is mandatory for the procedure so that the surgeon or radiologist can guide the trocars and monitor the cement injection. The vertebral body is entered via a posterior approach through the pedicle. *National Osteoporosis Foundation. Percutaneous Vertebroplasty. [Online] June 20, 2008 <www.vertebroplasty.com>.*
How does kyphoplasty differ from vertebroplasty?	Vertebroplasty involves the injection of cement directly into the vertebral body. During a kyphoplasty, a balloon is inflated inside the vertebral body prior to injection of a more viscous cement than that used for vertebroplasty. *Barash PG, Cullen BF, Stoelting RK, Cahalan MK, Stock MC, Ortega R. Clinical Anesthesia. 7th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Lippincott Williams and Wilkins; 2013: 1664.*
What are the pulmonary sequelae of symptomatic vertebral compression fractures?	Patients with symptomatic vertebral compression fractures suffer from a loss of vertebral height. As the vertebral column shortens, kyphosis and limited mobility result, which can lead to atelectasis, pneumonia, and deep vein thrombosis. *Barash PG, Cullen BF, Stoelting RK, Cahalan MK, Stock MC, Ortega R. Clinical Anesthesia. 7th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Lippincott Williams and Wilkins; 2013: 1664.*
What class of patients typically undergo vertebroplasty?	Because vertebral compression fractures often occur as a result of osteoporosis, the elderly are the most likely group to undergo vertebroplasty. *Barash PG, Cullen BF, Stoelting RK, Cahalan MK, Stock MC, Ortega R. Clinical Anesthesia. 7th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Lippincott Williams and Wilkins; 2013: 1664.*
What are the potential neurologic complications of vertebroplasty?	Radiculopathy, spinal claudication, and paraplegia are potential neurologic complications of vertebroplasty. *Barash PG, Cullen BF, Stoelting RK, Cahalan MK, Stock MC, Ortega R. Clinical Anesthesia. 7th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Lippincott Williams and Wilkins; 2013: 1664.*
Which is more likely to result in extravasation of cement, kyphoplasty or vertebroplasty?	Vertebroplasty is more likely to result in extravasation of the cement because the cement used in vertebroplasty is less viscous than that used for kyphoplasty. *Barash PG, Cullen BF, Stoelting RK, Cahalan MK, Stock MC, Ortega R. Clinical Anesthesia. 7th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Lippincott Williams and Wilkins; 2013: 1664.*

Copyright 2015 Prodigy Anesthesia, Inc. Unlawful to duplicate, distribute, or sell this document.

Prodigy Anesthesia Quick Review

Vertebroplasty

How is the patient positioned during and after a vertebroplasty?	The patient is positioned prone for the actual procedure and should remain supine for 3-5 hours after the procedure for evaluation of neurologic status and careful observation for bleeding. *Barash PG, Cullen BF, Stoelting RK, Cahalan MK, Stock MC, Ortega R. Clinical Anesthesia. 7th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Lippincott Williams and Wilkins; 2013: 1664.*
What type of cement is injected into the vertebra during a vertebroplasty? How much cement is typically injected?	2-6 mL of polymethyl methacrylate is injected into the vertebral body during a vertebroplasty. *Barash PG, Cullen BF, Stoelting RK, Cahalan MK, Stock MC, Ortega R. Clinical Anesthesia. 7th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Lippincott Williams and Wilkins; 2013: 1664.*
What forms of anesthesia are acceptable for vertebroplasty?	General anesthesia and IV sedation are both acceptable techniques when performing a vertebroplasty. *National Osteoporosis Foundation. Percutaneous Vertebroplasty. [Online] June 20, 2008 <www.vertebroplasty.com>.*

Copyright 2015 Prodigy Anesthesia, Inc. Unlawful to duplicate, distribute, or sell this document.